

ServiceNow Inc. (NOW)

2Q26 EPS: The AI use cases are becoming more tangible

NOW

12m Price Target: **\$152.00**

Price: **\$95.46**

Upside: **59.2%**

ServiceNow is indicated +5% post a mostly straightforward quarter: 2Q subscription revenue growth of +23% was 175bps above guidance. 2Q cRPO was 21.5%, 200bps above guidance (above the 3yr average cRPO beat of 150bps). FY26 subscription guidance is now for 21.0% yoy cc, raised to the high end and up 25bps at the midpoint. Given a number of crosscurrents to demand (e.g. the risk of elongated sales cycles and crowding out, federal, last quarter's ME pushouts), we view the solid beat as a good thing.

We continue to believe the single biggest driver of a stock rerating will be whether ServiceNow can prove its relevance in the enterprise AI stack, and we believe a stabilization in organic revenue and upward revisions to WholeCo revenue will help demonstrate this relevance. In our view, the most interesting product cycle for ServiceNow to execute this is L1 ITSM (for the IT support desk), which became GA in May and resolves 80-85% of service requests without human intervention. ServiceNow also noted new voice capabilities, with one airline customer running all customer service calls on ServiceNow's Voice AI, at 5mn annual calls. As adoption of these autonomous solutions accelerates, the complexity of tasks executed by agents will increase, driving more assists and consumption, and ultimately greater monetization. This quarter, ServiceNow surpassed \$1bn of AI ACV and reiterated confidence in exceeding its \$1.5bn AI ACV target by YE2026, and tracking ahead of its long term objective of 30% AI ACV by 2030. AI NNACV growth was 40%+ qoq; customers with AI in production increased 9x over the last nine months; and deal volume among first time AI buyers grew 45% yoy. We view AI ACV as more valuable than core workflow revenue as AI deployments increase customer entrenchment, drive greater workflow execution, and create a runway for future consumption growth.

BUY ^{CL}

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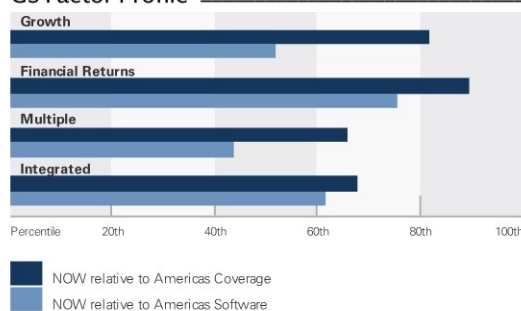
Key Data

Market cap: \$102.5bn
Enterprise value: \$103.1bn
3m ADTV: \$2.9bn
United States
Americas Software
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (\$ mn) New	13,278.0	16,220.5	19,340.1	22,965.4
Revenue (\$ mn) Old	13,278.0	16,213.6	19,376.1	23,022.1
EBITDA (\$ mn)	4,887.0	6,551.2	7,596.9	9,018.6
EBIT (\$ mn)	4,149.0	5,107.5	6,298.1	7,706.1
EPS (\$ New)	3.52	4.09	5.17	6.40
EPS (\$ Old)	3.52	4.14	5.17	6.44
P/E (X)	52.5	23.3	18.5	14.9
Dividend yield (%)	—	—	—	—
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.5)	0.1	(0.7)	(1.4)
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (\$)	0.90	1.03	1.18	1.21

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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ServiceNow Inc. (NOW)

Rating since Feb 1, 2019

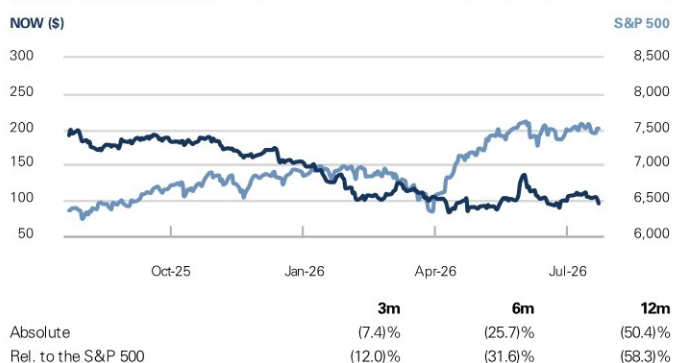
Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	52.5	23.3	18.5	14.9
EV/EBITDA (X)	38.8	15.2	12.4	9.8
EV/sales (X)	14.3	6.1	4.9	3.8
FCF yield (%)	2.4	5.3	6.9	8.2
EV/DACF (X)	37.6	17.1	13.1	10.3
CROCI (%)	48.5	39.3	41.6	50.3
ROE (%)	32.5	31.8	33.8	31.8
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.5)	0.1	(0.7)	(1.4)
Net debt/equity (%)	(17.2)	4.8	(28.5)	(51.1)
Interest cover (X)	230.5	—	—	—
Inventory days	NM	NM	NM	NM
Receivable days	66.9	64.0	59.6	53.5
Days payable outstanding	19.7	24.9	25.8	25.8

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	20.9	22.2	19.2	18.7
EBITDA growth	28.0	34.1	16.0	18.7
EPS growth	26.4	16.2	26.3	24.0
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	81.0	78.8	78.6	78.2
EBIT margin	31.2	31.5	32.6	33.6

Price Performance



Source: FactSet. Price as of 22 Jul 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	13,278.0	16,220.5	19,340.1	22,965.4
Cost of goods sold	(2,517.0)	(3,440.5)	(4,131.8)	(4,997.5)
SG&A	(4,464.0)	(5,189.6)	(6,017.7)	(6,920.9)
R&D	(2,148.0)	(2,482.9)	(2,892.5)	(3,340.9)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	4,887.0	6,551.2	7,596.9	9,018.6
Depreciation & amortization	(738.0)	(1,443.6)	(1,298.8)	(1,312.5)
EBIT	4,149.0	5,107.5	6,298.1	7,706.1
Net interest inc./exp.)	433.0	294.2	455.4	776.6
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	4,586.0	5,278.7	6,753.5	8,482.7
Provision for taxes	(917.0)	(1,039.3)	(1,350.7)	(1,696.5)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	3,669.0	4,239.4	5,402.8	6,786.2
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	1,748.0	1,664.1	3,082.0	4,581.5
EPS (basic, pre-except) (\$)	3.54	4.10	5.18	6.42
EPS (diluted, pre-except) (\$)	3.52	4.09	5.17	6.40
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) (\$)	--	--	--	--
DPS (\$)	—	—	—	—
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	1,037.3	1,033.1	1,042.3	1,056.3
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,042.1	1,036.6	1,045.8	1,059.8

Balance Sheet (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	3,726.0	4,773.0	10,647.9	17,911.3
Accounts receivable	2,627.0	3,064.0	3,256.2	3,470.3
Inventory	—	—	—	—
Other current assets	4,118.0	4,030.6	4,375.0	4,778.3
Total current assets	10,471.0	11,867.6	18,279.1	26,159.8
Net PP&E	3,095.0	3,037.1	3,188.9	3,369.1
Net intangibles	4,699.0	13,238.4	12,851.6	12,622.0
Total investments	5,313.0	4,116.0	4,116.0	4,116.0
Other long-term assets	2,460.0	2,574.4	2,878.8	3,234.3
Total assets	26,038.0	34,833.6	41,314.4	49,501.2
Accounts payable	204.0	264.7	320.4	386.9
Short-term debt	0.0	—	—	—
Current lease liabilities	112.0	114.0	114.0	114.0
Other current liabilities	10,127.0	13,795.1	15,609.9	17,607.2
Total current liabilities	10,443.0	14,173.8	16,043.3	18,108.1
Long-term debt	1,491.0	5,435.0	5,435.0	5,435.0
Non-current lease liabilities	800.0	822.0	822.0	822.0
Other long-term liabilities	220.0	605.0	605.0	605.0
Total long-term liabilities	2,631.0	6,957.9	6,972.1	6,987.3
Total liabilities	13,074.0	21,131.7	23,016.3	25,095.4
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	12,964.0	13,701.9	18,298.1	24,405.7
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	26,038.0	34,833.6	41,314.4	49,501.2
BVPS (\$)	12.50	13.26	17.56	23.11

Cash Flow (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	1,748.0	1,664.1	3,082.0	4,581.5
D&A add-back	738.0	1,443.6	1,298.8	1,312.5
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	29.0	(142.0)	313.6	242.2
Others	2,929.0	2,984.4	3,244.3	3,390.3
Cash flow from operations	5,444.0	5,950.2	7,938.6	9,526.5
Capital expenditures	(911.0)	(678.2)	(1,063.7)	(1,263.1)
Acquisitions	(1,084.0)	(8,776.0)	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	306.0	1,926.0	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(1,689.0)	(7,528.2)	(1,063.7)	(1,263.1)
Dividends paid	—	—	—	—
Share issuance/(repurchase)	(1,840.0)	(3,225.0)	(1,000.0)	(1,000.0)
Inc/(dec) in debt	—	—	—	—
Others	(493.0)	5,850.0	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	(2,333.0)	2,625.0	(1,000.0)	(1,000.0)
Total cash flow	1,422.0	1,047.0	5,874.9	7,263.4
Free cash flow	4,533.0	5,272.0	6,874.9	8,263.4
Free cash flow per share (basic) (\$)	4.37	5.10	6.60	7.82

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

Earnings Recap

Exhibit 1: 2Q26 Actuals vs. Estimates

\$ millions, unless specified	Actual	GSe	2Q26A Street	Actual vs GSe	Actual vs Street
Subscription Revenue	\$3,877	\$3,817	\$3,817	1.6%	1.6%
% yoy	24.5%	23%	23%		
% yoy CC	23.0%	21%			
Total Revenue	\$3,987	\$3,934	\$3,927	1.4%	2%
% yoy	24.0%	22%	22%		
% yoy CC	22.5%				
Gross Profit	\$3,107	\$3,122	\$3,111	-0.5%	-0.1%
% margin	78%	79%	79%		
% yoy	19%	20%	19%		
Operating Income	\$1,173	\$1,043	\$1,043	12.4%	12.5%
% Margin	29%	27%	27%		
% yoy	23%	9%	9%		
Earnings Per Share	\$0.90	\$0.86	\$0.86	4.6%	4.8%
% yoy	10%	5%	5%		
cRPO	\$13,200	\$12,995	\$12,997	1.6%	1.6%
% yoy	21.0%	19%	19%		
% yoy CC	21.5%	20%			
Total deferred revenue	\$8,192	\$8,352	\$8,213	-1.9%	-0.3%
% yoy	19%	21%	19%		
Free Cash Flow	\$634	\$656	\$691	-3.3%	-8.2%
% Margin	16%	17%	18%		

Source: FactSet, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and Key Risks

We maintain our Buy rating and raise our 12-month price target to \$152 (from \$145) based on a 27x P/E multiple (unchanged) to ServiceNow's SNTM (Q5-Q8) non-GAAP earnings. Our 2026/2027/2028 subscription revenue estimates go to \$15,770/\$18,829/\$22,388 (from \$15,756/\$18,852/\$22,425) on the back of results.

Key downside risks include: 1) Slowing momentum in new market expansion reducing growth trajectory, 2) Lack of adoption of AI solutions and disintermediation of existing solutions by competitor AI technologies, and 3) Higher expense growth limiting margin expansion.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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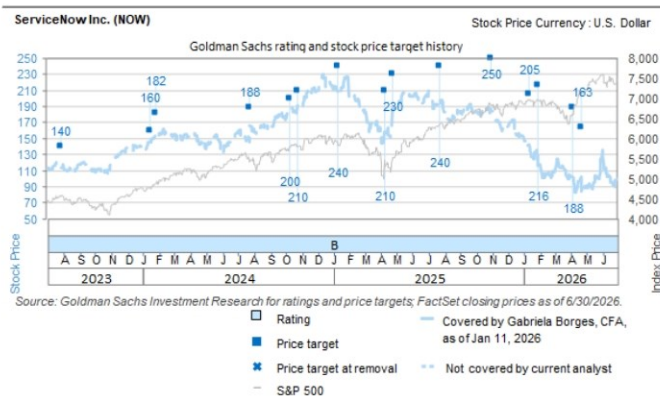
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Target price history table(s)

ServiceNow Inc. (NOW)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
08-Jul-26	145.00	107.78
23-Apr-26	163.00	84.78
06-Apr-26	188.00	102.42
29-Jan-26	216.00	116.73
11-Jan-26	205.00	141.80
30-Oct-25	1,250.00	186.94
24-Jul-25	1,200.00	199.24
24-Apr-25	1,150.00	187.71
10-Apr-25	1,050.00	156.70
10-Jan-25	1,200.00	204.91
24-Oct-24	1,050.00	191.32
10-Oct-24	1,000.00	188.93
25-Jul-24	940.00	165.76
25-Jan-24	910.00	153.34
16-Jan-24	800.00	145.51
27-Jul-23	700.00	111.98

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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